

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

If we don't do anything about the environment, we will face serious problems!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you worry about environmental issues? Why or why not?
- What cause do you support? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can talk about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.
- I can ask for clarification.

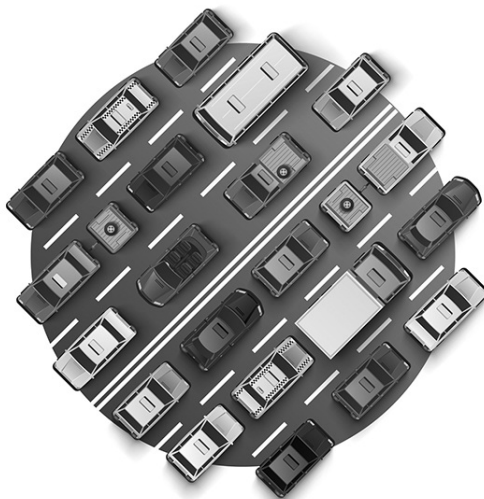




Let's Explore!

Sally interviews an environmental activist. What is he **advocating***?

* When you "advocate" for something you argue for or support a cause or policy.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Next year, the city of Cambridge is planning to build a new highway that will run from the east part of the city to the west. The highway should relieve some of the traffic coming downtown from the suburbs. If things go as planned, construction will begin next summer. Environmentalists' groups are protesting the construction of this new highway. They say that if the city decided to build it, the pollution level would increase exponentially. John Smits, you are the head of "Citizens for Green", a climate change activist group. How do you think we can avoid this environmental issue?
- John Smits:** The city could work on a better public transit system instead of planning more roads. If more people used buses, there would be less traffic and better air for us to breathe. The smog here will be as bad as in Boston if we go ahead with the proposed plan.
- Sally:** Can you tell us how you are going to put pressure on the city officials?
- John Smits:** We are organizing a protest in front of the city hall on Sunday.
- Sally:** What would you suggest to our listeners if they wanted to get more involved?
- John Smits:** If we want a better future for our children, we will need to make sure our air stays clean. I wouldn't choose parking lots over green spaces.





Let's Practice!

Sally talks to an environmental activist. What will happen if ... ?

Instructions: Match the words to each sentence. Read the completed sentences aloud. Compare your pronunciation with a partner. Model a conversation. Switch roles.

COLUMN A:

COLUMN B:

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. If things go as planned | a. there would be less traffic and better air for us to breathe. |
| 2. If we keep producing CO ₂ | b. climate change will continue to be a problem. |
| 3. If the city decided to build it | c. if we go ahead with the proposed plan. |
| 4. The smog will be as bad as Boston's | d. construction will begin next summer. |
| 5. If more people used buses | e. the pollution level would increase exponentially. |



Let's Practice!

Sally asks for clarification.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Cross out the incorrect word.

- 1) Can you tell us how you are going to two put pressure on not the city officials?
- 2) How do you iu think we can avoid it this environmental issue?
- 3) What would you suggest to our listeners back if they wanted desire to get more involved?
- 4) How do you think again we can help you the environment?
- 5) What would wood you suggest the city do to improve traffic transpor?





Extension Activity

Prepare a presentation about environmental problems.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a list of five of the biggest problems facing our environment. Make a short presentation 3 to 5 minutes long discussing these problems.
- Make suggestions about some of the things we can do to help the environment.
- Discuss the suggestions with a partner.
- Ask for clarification about your partner's suggestions.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss how to deal with problems.

☐ ☐

I talk about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐

I ask for clarification.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- environmental** (adjective): relating to the world and the impact humanity has on it
e.g. How do you think we can avoid this environmental issue?
- suburbs** (noun): the urban area surrounding the downtown core
e.g. The highway should relieve some of the traffic coming downtown from the suburbs.
- environmentalist** (noun): a person who advocates the protection of the environment
e.g. Environmentalists are protesting the construction of this new highway.
- climate change** (noun): a change in global weather patterns largely caused by pollution
e.g. John Smits is the head of a climate change activist group.
- to put pressure on** (verb): to make demands on someone
e.g. Can you tell us how you are going to put pressure on the city officials?
- smog** (noun): fog or haze combined with smoke and pollution
e.g. The smog here will be as bad as in Boston if we go ahead with the proposed plan.





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences with *If* Clause

You use the first conditional with *If* clauses to talk about real possibilities in the future.

You use the second conditional to talk about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will do or not do something. In that condition, something else may, will or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If* clause and the *Condition* clause.

You use the Second Conditional to talk about hypothetical situations. It's not certain that it's possible to fulfill the condition.

Example:

If I had a million dollars, I would buy a car.

Do you have a million dollars? No.

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.

What would you do if you had a million dollars? Buy a car.

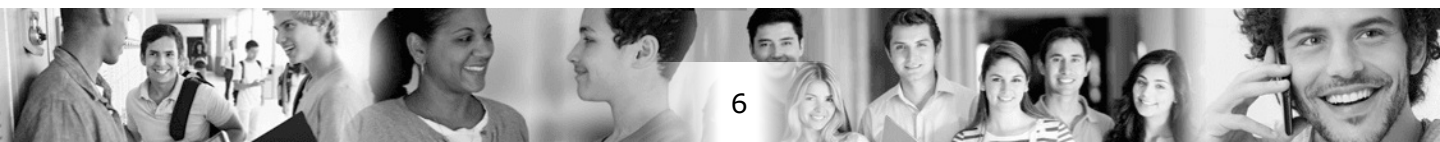
You use the **Simple Past verb + *would***





Learning Points

First Conditional: 1st Clause	First Conditional: 2nd Clause	Meaning
<i>If things go as planned,</i>	<i>construction will begin next year.</i>	It's possible that things will go as planned. In this condition, construction will begin.
<i>If we want a better future,</i>	<i>we will need to make sure our air stays clean.</i>	It's possible we will want a better future. In this condition, we will need to make sure our air is clean.
Second Conditional: <i>If ... + Simple Past</i>	Second Conditional: <i>would + base verb</i>	Result
<i>If the city decided to build the highway,</i>	<i>the pollution level would increase.</i>	It is not certain that the city will build the highway. What would happen if it did? The pollution level would increase.
<i>If more people used buses,</i>	<i>there would be less traffic.</i>	It is not certain that more people will use buses. What would happen if they did? There would be less traffic.





Learning Points

Modals for Suggestions

When you want to offer advice or give solutions to a problem, you use modals like *might*, *should* or *could*.

These modals can go at the beginning of the sentence, or after a clause starting with "If ...".

The modal is followed by a verb in the base form. You do not use "to".

I would / I'd ...
I wouldn't ...
You could ...
You should ...

Examples:

- *The highway should relieve some of the traffic coming downtown from the suburbs.*
- *The city could work on a better public transit system instead of planning more roads.*
- *I wouldn't choose parking lots over green spaces.*

